

Ψευδο-Πολέμων

Pseudo-Polemon on Physiognomics and Character

eul_aid: pwi

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Sophist](#)

Pseudo-Polemon is the name given to an unknown author from the 2nd century CE during the Roman Imperial period. This anonymous writer composed a Greek treatise on physiognomy, the practice of judging a person's character from their physical appearance. The work was falsely attributed in later manuscripts to the famous orator Antonius Polemon, which is how the pseudonym originated. Nothing is known about the actual author's life or background.

The author's only known work is the **Physiognomonica**. This surviving text details methods for assessing moral disposition based on features like facial structure, body movements, and resemblances to animals. According to modern scholars, the treatise synthesizes earlier Greek theories on the subject, possibly connected to traditions from Aristotle's school. The false attribution to the well-known sophist Polemon is believed to have been a strategy to give the text greater authority and help ensure its preservation.

The work is historically significant as a major source for understanding ancient pseudo-scientific thought. It reflects broader Roman-era interests in rhetoric, character analysis, and classifying human nature. Its influence extended beyond the ancient world, as the text was later translated and studied in the Byzantine and Arabic medieval traditions.

Works (2)

- Φυσιогνωμονικά · [Physiognomics](#) · 15 passages
- Φυσιогνωμονικά · [Physiognomics, Adamantian Epitome](#) · 70 passages

Other Sophist Authors

- Ἀχιλλεὺς ὁ Τατίος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · [Achilles Tatius of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- Κλαύδιος Αἰλιανός · [Aelian of Praeneste](#) · 4 works
- Πόπλιος Αἴλιος Ἀριστείδης Θεόδωρος · [Aelius Aristides of Smyrna](#) · 3 works
- Αἴλιος Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀλικαρνασσεύς · [Aelius Dionysius of Halicarnassus](#) · 1 work
- Αἴλιος Θεών ὁ σοφιστής · [Aelius Theon the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλκιδάμας ὁ Ἐλαεύς · [Alcidamas of Elaea](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλκίφρων ὁ Σοφιστής · [Alciphron the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ τοῦ Νουμήνιου · [Alexander Son of Numenius](#) · 2 works

- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Alexander the Ephesian Poet · 1 work
- Ἀμφικράτης Ἀθηναῖος · Amphicrates Atheniensis · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς Ἀφθόνιον · Anonymous Commentary on Aphthonius · 2 works
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Antiphon of Athens · 9 works